



Bering Strait

This satellite image shows the Bering Strait, a 56-mile (96-km) stretch of water that separates Asia and North America.

importation of **opium**. Chinese goods were in high demand in Europe, but the Chinese were unimpressed by European goods and accepted payment only in silver—which Britain, in particular, had to obtain at exorbitant cost. In the early 18th century, British traders had begun to trade Indian opium for Chinese goods, and there was soon a growing number of **addicted Chinese** that greatly reduced Europe's silver requirement. European opium smugglers remained a major problem for China into the 19th century.

Also in 1729, after more than a decade of mistreatment, **Natchez American Indians killed** more than 200 French **settlers at Fort Rosalie**, Mississippi. However, by 1731 the French, assisted by the Choctaw people, were to retaliate by enslaving a large

number of Natchez for work on Caribbean plantations.

The short-lived **Ottoman Tulip Period** (1718–30) was ended by a rebellion against unpopular measures led by a janissary (soldier), **Patrona Halil**, that caused Sultan Ahmed III to be supplanted by Mahmud I. The Tulip Period was one of stability in the Ottoman Empire and was marked by increased interest in Western ways. Just as Western

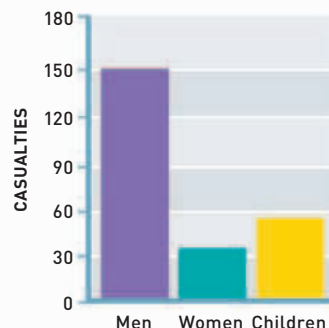


tulips in the 17th century, the Ottoman court became equally

obsessed. Ottoman **architecture and art were invigorated**, but high prices for tulips and tulip bulbs distorted the economy. The instatement of Mahmud I in 1730 brought an end to the Tulip Period, but **Halil was strangled** in front of the sultan in 1731 for overreaching himself.

In **Japan**, whose population had been ruled by the Tokugawa shogunate since 1603, there was a resurgence of the **Shinto religion**. Beginning around 1730, it was fueled by the writings of scholars such as Kada no Azumamaro (1669–1736) and Kamo no Mabuchi (1697–1769). The Shinto scholars rejected Chinese and Buddhist influences and sought to identify a purely **Japanese spiritual identity**. Shintoism was reinstated as the national religion of Japan more than a century later in 1868.

Meanwhile, the Arabian state of **Oman** was expanding its dominions in Africa. The Portuguese-held Kenyan city



Massacre at Fort Rosalie

On November 28, 1729, Natchez American Indians killed 242 settlers at Fort Rosalie, Mississippi, in retaliation for years of mistreatment.

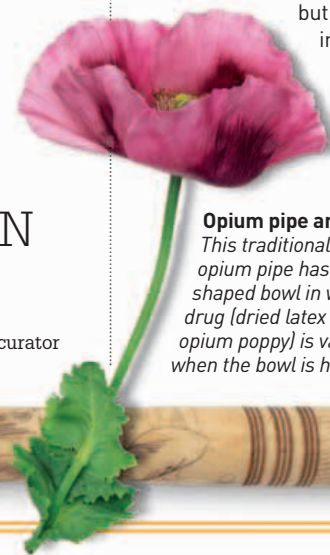
of **Mombasa** and the island of Pemba had been captured by the Omanis in 1698, and by 1730 they had driven the Portuguese from the Kenyan and Tanzanian coasts and gained control of the island of **Zanzibar** (now part of Tanzania).

In **West Africa**, Islamic Fulbe, or Fulani, people began to unify into larger communities in what is now known as

the **Fulbe Revolution**. The first such state was Bondou, in Guinea, formed in the late 17th century. Then came Futa Jallon (centered in Guinea but sprawling over neighboring territories), where the Islamic Fulbe took power from the existing leaders and non-Islamic Fulbe people.

A **confederation of provinces** was formally created in 1735 with its capital at Timbo, Guinea. Other areas that were profoundly affected by the Fulbe Jihad—as the seizure of power was termed—included the formerly declining **Bornu Empire** (in present-day Nigeria), the fortunes of which underwent a significant revival.

In 1731, formerly independent **Dahomey** in West Africa finally accepted the suzerainty of the **Yoruba Oyo Empire** (present-day Nigeria). The Yoruba had invaded and defeated them after a protracted and bitterly fought campaign in 1728, but resistance in Dahomey did not end until 1748.



Opium pipe and poppy
This traditional Chinese opium pipe has a knob-shaped bowl in which the drug (dried latex from the opium poppy) is vaporized when the bowl is heated.

“...IN LESS THAN TWO HOURS THEY MASSACRED MORE THAN 200 OF THE FRENCH.”

Father le Petit, missionary, in a letter to Father D'Avaugour, Procurator of the Missions in North America, 1730

August 14, 1728 Danish explorer Vitus Bering discovers Bering Strait is eastward limit of Siberia

1728 Nigerian Oyo Empire invades Dahomey

April 21, 1729 Catherine II (the Great) of Russia born (d. 1796)

November 9, 1729 Britain, France, Spain, and Dutch Republic sign Treaty of Seville

1729 Qing emperor bans sale and smoking of opium in China

September 1730 Patrona Halil leads rebellion that topples Ottoman emperor Ahmed III

March 16, 1731 Austria, Britain, Dutch Republic, and Spain sign Treaty of Vienna

October 20–23, 1728 More than a quarter of Copenhagen, Denmark, destroyed by fire

1729 Persians under Nader Shah defeat occupying Afghans in Battle of Damghan

July 30, 1729 City of Baltimore, Maryland, founded

November 28, 1729 Natchez American Indians kill settlers at Fort Rosalie, Mississippi

January 29, 1730 Anna of Russia becomes czarina on death of Peter II (b. 1715) from smallpox

September 20, 1730 Mahmud I succeeds Ahmed III as Ottoman emperor

1731 Dahomey accepts suzerainty of Nigerian Oyo Empire